

Sales Pipeline Copilot

Every step, start to finish, including the current (2026) way to build the tool in Step 6 — a single Dataverse connector action, no flow required.

i

What You're Building

An agent that gives sellers pipeline insight and lets them update CRM deals in conversation, grounded in one data file, acting through a single governed connector action.

AGENT NAME	Sales Pipeline Copilot
ORCHESTRATION	Generative (AI-led)
KNOWLEDGE	Sales_Pipeline_Data.xlsx
CUSTOM TOPIC	Update Deal Stage
TOOL	Update Opportunity (Dataverse connector — direct, no flow)

Files & Where They Go

FILE / ITEM	GOES TO	USED IN
Sales_Pipeline_Data.xlsx	Copilot Studio → Knowledge tab → Add knowledge → File	Step 3

No extra prerequisite artifact is needed for Step 6 — the tool uses your CRM's existing Opportunity table directly.

Before you start — confirm you have Environment Maker permission on the target Power Platform environment, and that a Dataverse Opportunity table (standard Sales app) exists in it.

Set Up the Agent

Steps 1–3 — create the agent shell, pick how it reasons, and ground it in data.

1 Create Your Copilot Studio Agent

Open Copilot Studio (copilotstudio.microsoft.com), select **Create** → **New agent**, then configure:

AGENT NAME	Sales Pipeline Copilot
DESCRIPTION	Sellers and managers get pipeline insight, deal-health flags, and in-line CRM actions without leaving Teams.
SOLUTION / ENVIRONMENT	Sales Solution · Default environment
ICON	Use a recognisable colour and emoji or upload a brand icon

2 Choose Orchestration Mode

Under **Settings** → **Generative AI**, use **Generative Orchestration** (AI-led) so the agent can blend knowledge lookups with tool calls for sales pipeline management.

3 Add Knowledge

Knowledge tab → **Add knowledge** → **File** → upload **Sales_Pipeline_Data.xlsx**. Contains:

- Account details (account name, industry, region)
- Deal details (stage, amount, probability, product line, lead source)
- Ownership (account executive)
- Time data (expected close date, last activity date, days in stage)

You can layer additional sources later — SharePoint sites, Dataverse, public web, or Graph connectors.

Behavior: Instructions & Topic

Steps 4–5 — tell the agent how to behave, then give it a reusable conversation flow.

4 Add Agent Instructions

Overview → Instructions — paste exactly:

You are the Sales Pipeline Copilot. You help two audiences:

- 1) Account executives reviewing their own deals.
- 2) Sales managers reviewing their team or region.

Rules:

- Use the uploaded opportunity data as your single source of truth.
- For analytical questions, calculate from the rows and explain method.
- For deal updates (stage, close date, next step), call the CRM tool.
- Flag stalled deals (no activity > 21 days) and slipping close dates.
- Never quote pipeline numbers across regions a user does not own.

5 Add a Custom Topic

Topics → Add a topic → Create from description:

Topic name: Update Deal Stage

Description: Lets a seller move an opportunity to a new stage and capture the next step in one conversational turn.

Trigger phrases:

- Move Cobalt Insurance to Negotiate
- Update the stage on deal OPP3015
- Set next step on the Northwind deal
- Progress my deal to Propose

Conversation steps:

- Identify the opportunity by name or ID (confirm if ambiguous)
- Ask for the new stage and the next step
- Look up current stage from knowledge and show the change
- Call the 'Update Opportunity' tool with the new values
- Confirm the update succeeded and offer to draft a follow-up email

Build the Tool (Current Method)

Step 6 — updated for 2026, using current Copilot Studio tool-building.

6 Add the Tool — Direct Connector, No Flow

This tool is a single native action, so current Copilot Studio lets you skip building a flow entirely:

1. **Tools** → **Add a tool** → **Connectors** → search **Dataverse** → select **Update a row**.
2. **Table name:** Opportunities (your CRM's standard Opportunity table).
3. **Row ID:** map to the Opportunity ID the agent collects from conversation.
4. **Update fields:** stage/salesstage → New stage; estimated close date → Expected close date; a next-step/description field → Next step.
5. **Add and configure** → Name: **Update Opportunity**. Description: "Updates stage, close date, and next step on a CRM opportunity record." — specific descriptions are how the orchestrator picks the right tool.
6. **Save**.

Rule of thumb — only reach for an agent flow (Flows → New flow) when a tool needs more than one action, like writing a record *and* posting a notification. A single connector action such as this one attaches directly as a tool, no flow ceremony required.

Original spec, for reference — Tool: Update Opportunity. Type: Dataverse connector (Update row on 'opportunity' table). Updates stage, close date, and next step on a CRM opportunity record. Inputs: Opportunity ID (string); New stage (Qualify / Discover / Propose / Negotiate / Closed Won / Closed Lost); Expected close date (date); Next step (string). Outcome: Returns success and the new last-modified timestamp.

Configure, Evaluate, Test, Publish

Steps 7–10 — lock down settings, prove quality, and ship it.

7 Configure Settings

Settings cog (top right) — four areas before real users touch the agent:

- **General** — confirm name, description, primary language
- **Generative AI** — orchestration mode, content moderation (start at Medium)
- **Authentication** — "Authenticate with Microsoft" so the agent runs as the signed-in user
- **Security** — review DLP policy, enabled channels, end-user authentication

8 Evaluate Your Agent

Analytics → **Evaluations** → **New evaluation** — "Sales Pipeline Copilot — Baseline v1". Score every response on Groundedness, Relevance, Accuracy.

Input: Show me my pipeline by stage with weighted value
 Expect: Calculates weighted value as amount × probability per row, sums by stage.

Input: Which deals haven't had activity in 21 days?
 Expect: Returns rows where Last Activity Date is more than 21 days before today.

Input: Move Cobalt Insurance to Negotiate and set next step to 'Procurement review'
 Expect: Triggers Update Deal Stage topic and calls Update Opportunity tool.

9 Test in the Test Pane

For each query, open **Activity map** to see: which topic/tool/knowledge fired, the inputs collected and outputs returned, citations to source rows, and per-step latency.

10 Publish to a Channel

Publish (top right) → **Channels**: Microsoft Teams (needs admin approval), Microsoft 365 Copilot, custom web embed, or Slack/Facebook/Telephony. Admin approval will not land inside a short workshop — the Test pane is your real finish line on the day.

Try These Live

Sample queries to run once the agent is built — and what it replaces.

Pipeline Health

- Show pipeline by stage with total and weighted value.
- What is the average days-in-stage by stage?

Risk & Slippage

- List opportunities where Last Activity Date is more than 21 days ago.
- Show deals with close date in the past that are still open.

In-line CRM Actions

- Move the AlpenTech deal to Propose, close date next Friday.
- Set next step on the Northwind Bank deal to 'Legal redline this week'.

This agent replaces

- Hunting through CRM dashboards
- Switching to CRM just to update a stage
- Manual weighted forecast roll-ups

With

- Pipeline insight where sellers already work
- CRM updates in a single conversational turn
- Sharper forecast conversations with managers

Tip for real-world use — use Dataverse-native security roles so sellers see only their own book, managers see their team, and execs see the region. The Copilot Studio agent inherits those permissions automatically.